

**FLASHES
DANCE**
Kent is going to the NCAA Tournament after a win over Miami in Saturday's MAC title game.
D7



DAN COUGHLIN
New deal means George Karl can finally repay that drink
Page E2

NPSL
Crunch claim 15-13 win over visiting Detroit
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COLLEGE BASKETBALL
UCLA upset by Washington; Indiana tops Illinois in Big Ten
Pages D6-7

Sports

The Chronicle-Telegram Sunday, March 11, 2001 **D1**

Vizquel a hero in Venezuela

Omar is honored alongside country's great shortstops

The Associated Press

VALENCIA, Venezuela — Omar Vizquel glanced left and right and hoped he saw his future.

Sandwiched between Luis Aparicio, Venezuela's first Hall of Famer, and second-generation star Dave Concepcion, Vizquel knew he had inherited a proud tradition as Venezuela's latest stellar shortstop.

"I feel like I'm in the World Series," Vizquel said before Saturday's game between the Cleveland Indians and Houston Astros. "Every time they compare me to Aparicio and Concepcion I feel proud."

The Indians won the game, 7-6. The second of the two-game Venezuela exhibition is today at noon (WEOL 930-AM, WTAM 1100-AM).

Vizquel, 33, is entering his seventh season with Cleveland, which obtained him from Seattle in 1993. He hit .287 last year with seven homers and 66 RBIs and had perhaps his finest sea-

See VIZQUEL, D3



Chris Assenheimer

Dolan is proud, and says fans should be, too

Larry Dolan's rookie year didn't quite go the way he expected.

The Indians were hit by an inordinate amount of injuries to their pitching staff and they missed out on the playoffs for the first time in six years — not exactly the way you want to begin your regime.

Dolan suffered right along with the rest of his Cleveland kin as the mighty Indians were knocked from their characteristically comfy perch atop the American League Central Division.

It was the beginning of an early legacy of doom for the native Clevelanders.

Since acquiring the team from Dick Jacobs on Feb. 7 of last year, Dolan has seen the departure of fan favorites Manny Ramirez and Sandy Alomar, the end of a five-year play-off run and now the imminent halt to the Tribe's major-league

See DOLAN, D3

MORE INDIANS

STICK AROUND FOR A WHILE: Indians renew the contract of Einar Diaz, indicate they are working toward a long-term deal with the team's new catcher.
Page E1.

Keystone's run skids to a halt

Wildcats blitzed by Patrick Henry in 43-15 defeat

Scott Brown
The Chronicle-Telegram

LEXINGTON — These are the games players dread.

Where every pass seems to find its way into opposing hands. Where every shot elicits a clunk off the rim instead of cheers from the crowd. Where just get-

ting the ball over half-court is a moral victory.

These games happen. Unfortunately for Keystone's Wildcats, Saturday was their turn.

The greatest season in Wildcat basketball history hit the wall in a 43-15 loss to Hamler Patrick Henry in a Division III regional championship game at Lexington High School.

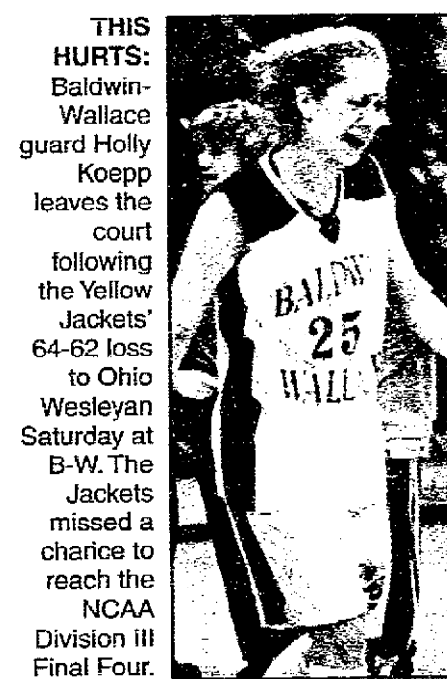
Keystone (21-4) finished with the most wins in school history. The Wildcats, district champs for

See KEYSTONE, D2



TOM MAHL / CHRONICLE

ONE WIN SHORT: Keystone players (from left) Erin Shaw, Brandy Terry and Jessica Fraley watch while Patrick Henry is awarded the regional championship trophy following the teams' Division III game on Saturday. Patrick Henry won, 43-15.



LINDA MURPHY / CHRONICLE

THIS HURTS: Baldwin-Wallace guard Holly Koepf leaves the court following the Yellow Jackets' 64-62 loss to Ohio Wesleyan Saturday at B-W. The Jackets missed a chance to reach the NCAA Division III Final Four.

Jackets stunned by loss

Ohio Wesleyan upsets Baldwin-Wallace, takes coveted Final Four berth

Scott Petrak
The Chronicle-Telegram

BEREA — Face-down on the floor, eyes welling with tears is not how Holly Koepf envisioned this season ending.

Until Emily Clark's 12-footer spun out after being halfway down, Koepf believed Baldwin-Wallace was destined for the first Final Four in school history.

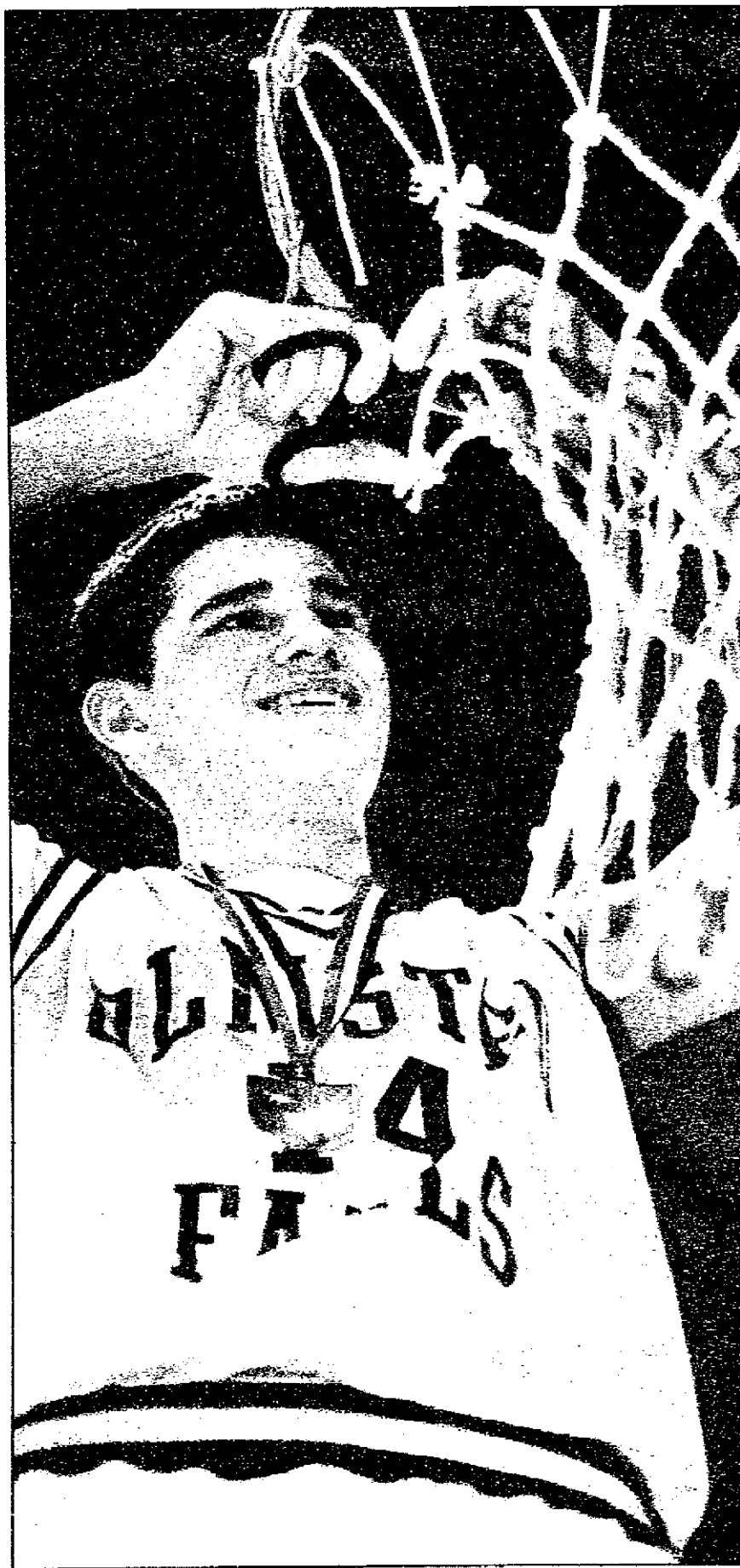
"Some things aren't meant to work out," the Lorain Catholic graduate said.

Apparently not.

The third-ranked Yellow Jackets lost 64-62 to unranked Ohio Wesleyan in the Elite Eight round of the NCAA Division III Tournament at Ursprung Gymnasium on B-W's campus Saturday. Wesleyan advances to play Messiah (Pa.) on Friday in Danbury, Conn.

"There was never a time when I thought we would lose," said Koepf, who scored 10 points and grabbed eight rebounds in 13 foul-plagued minutes. "I thought for sure we'd win."

See JACKETS, D5



STEVE MANHEIM / CHRONICLE

OH, WHAT A FEELING: Olmsted Falls' Dan Binggeri cuts off his share of the net following Olmsted Falls' 64-47 Division II district championship game win over Avon Lake on Saturday at Admiral King. The Bulldogs, with a record of 19-4, advance to the regional semifinals at Cleveland State on Wednesday. They play Tallmadge at 6:15 p.m.

District, war go to Falls

Gansey scores 30 points as 'Dogs win 3rd meeting with Avon Lake, 64-47

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — It had all the makings of a classic district final.

But in the end, Olmsted Falls proved to be too much for Avon Lake to handle as the Bulldogs advance to their seventh "Sweet 16" since 1990 with a convincing 64-47 victory over the Shoremen.

Falls, now 19-4, will play third-ranked Tallmadge (23-0) at 6:15 p.m. Wednesday at the Cleveland State Convocation Center. The winner advances to Bowling Green for the regional title game on Saturday.

Avon Lake bowed out at 20-4.

The win capped a tremendous season series between the two bitter Southwestern Conference rivals. Avon Lake won the first meeting on Jan. 19, but Falls won the games that counted the most — Feb. 23 for the league title and Saturday for the district crown.

Falls also avenged a 57-47 loss to Avon Lake in last year's district final.

"I watched the tape of it from last year," said Falls star Mike Gansey. "It made me want to beat them that much more."

Gansey, shut out over the first eight minutes of the game, wound up with 30 points, 10 rebounds, four assists and three blocked shots to lead the Bulldogs.

Tom Port scored 21 to lead the Shoremen. He added 15 rebounds and three assists.

The difference turned out to be defense, as it usually is at this time of year.

"Their (Shoremen) zone at the beginning kind of rattled us," Gansey said. "I was trying too many outside shots and not taking it to the hoop."

"They went to the man (second half) and that helped us a lot."

"I was happy with the first half the way we came out and played," said Avon Lake coach Dave Olinger. "Especially the first quarter where Mike (Gansey) wasn't real involved. In the second quarter, he got away from us and we turned the ball over too many times. It kind of snowballed from there."

A layup by Port to start the second quarter put the

See FALLS, D3



Gansey
.....30 points

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